BOARD REPORT · OCT 2025 TO SEP 2026

Complaints: what we found and what we will do

Fictional example for Northgate Advisory (fictional). The data is invented to show the format. It is not a client result.

Executive summary

120 complaints were received in the year; 63% were upheld at least in part and the average case took 15.5 working days against a 15-day target. Volumes peaked in Jun, after the fee-schedule change. The records point to causes the firm can fix, set out below with an owner for each action.

The year at a glance

120 complaints in twelve months. 63% were upheld at least in part.

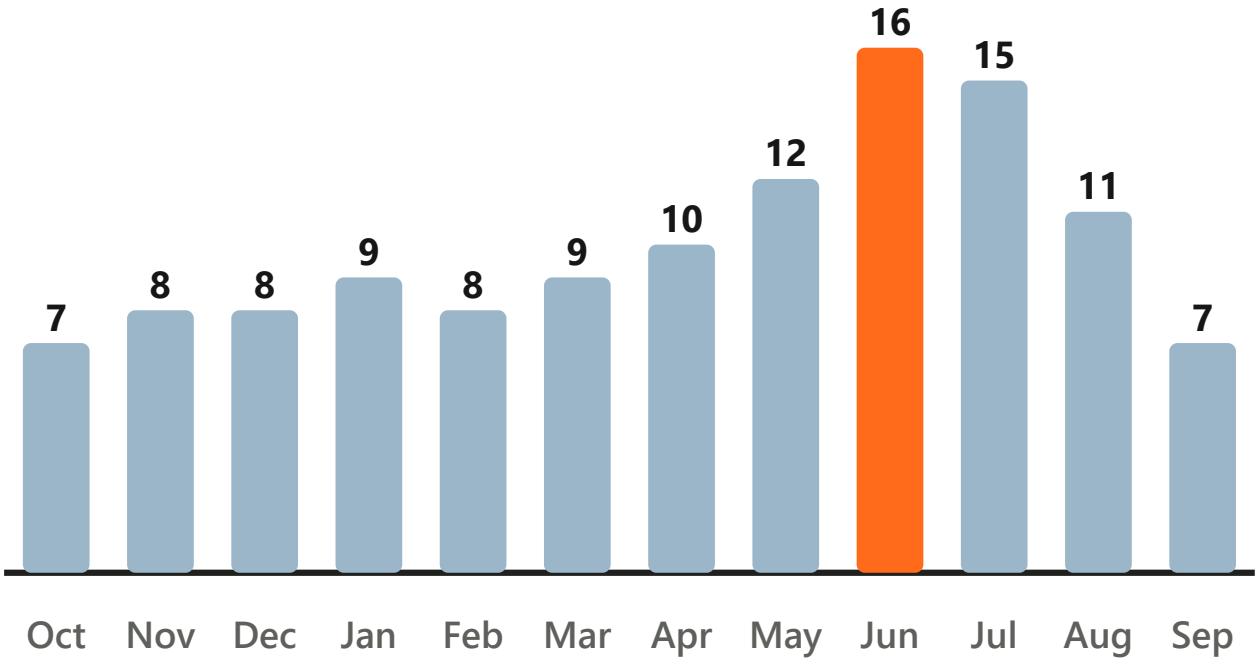
Complaints	Upheld, wholly or partly
120	63%
Oct 2025 to Sep 2026	

Average days to close	Closed within target
15.5	51%
Target 15 working days	

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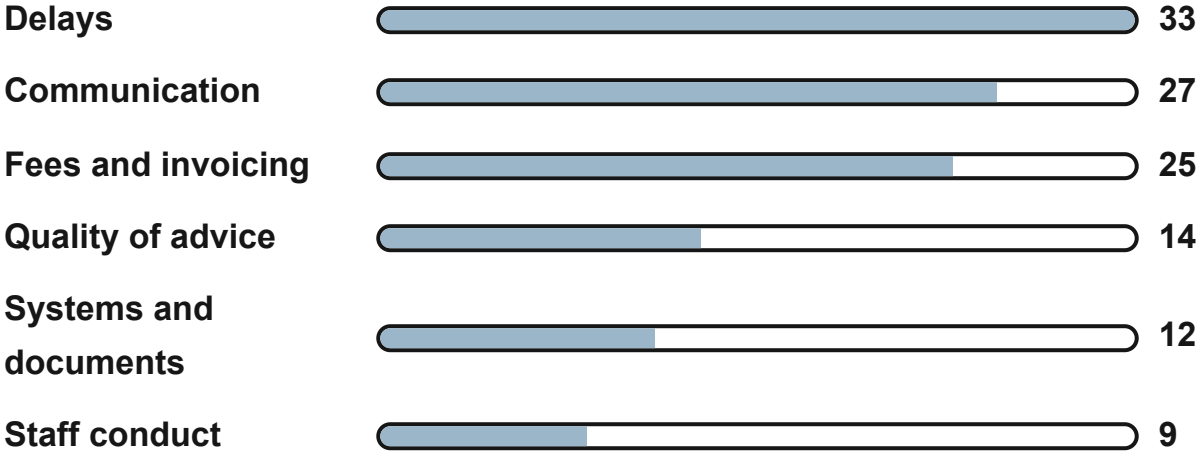
Volumes peaked after the fee change

Complaints peaked in Jun. The last quarter (33) is still above the first (23).



What the complaints were about

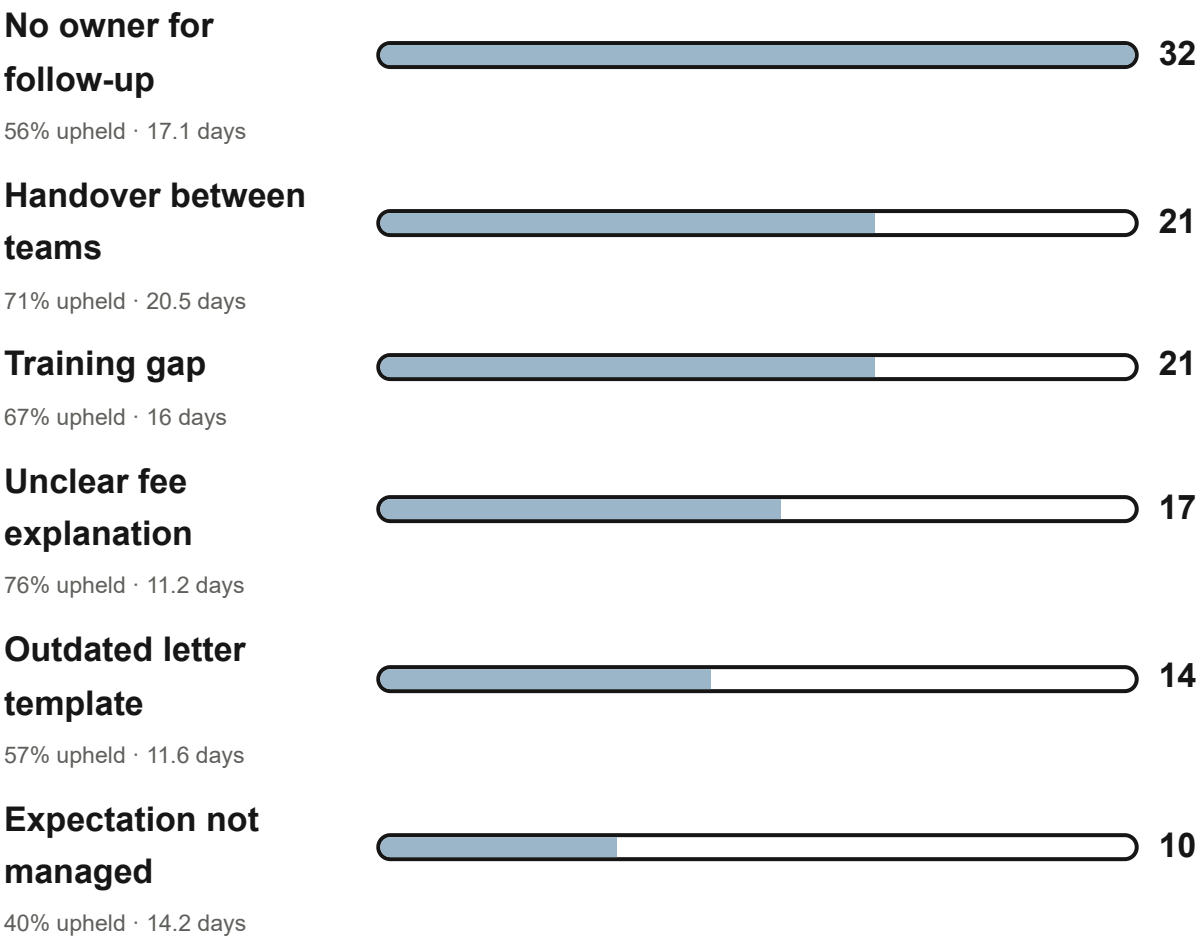
The three biggest categories (Delays, Communication, Fees and invoicing) make up 71% of complaints.



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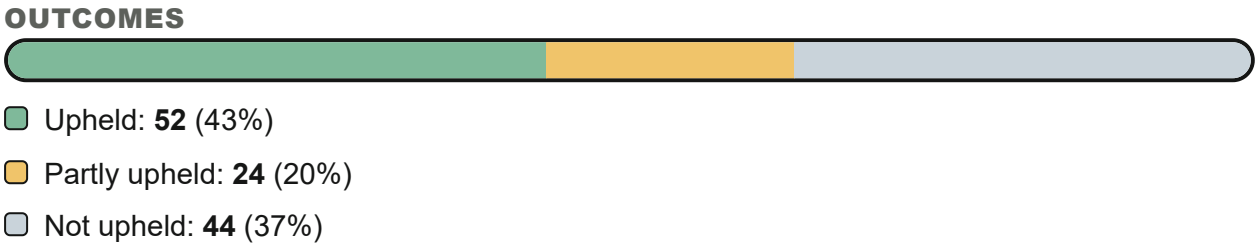
Why they happened (root causes)

No owner for follow-up and handover between teams together explain 45% of complaints.



Outcomes and timeliness

49% of complaints ran past the 15-day target.



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What management should do next

6 actions, each with an owner and a date.

Action	Owner	By
Name one case owner on every complaint, who keeps it to the end	Complaints lead	16 Nov 2026
Rewrite the fee explanation sent at engagement	Head of client services	30 Nov 2026
Add “next action” and date fields to the tracker	Operations manager	9 Nov 2026
Brief handlers on investigation and reply standards (two short sessions)	Team managers	4 Dec 2026
Report cases older than 10 working days at the weekly meeting	Complaints lead	23 Nov 2026
Refresh the four complaint letter templates	Compliance officer	18 Dec 2026

Findings in brief

1. **No owner for follow-up is the biggest single cause.** 32 of 120 complaints (27%), and 56% of them were upheld at least in part. *Next: Name one case owner on every complaint, with a next-action date.*
2. **Fee complaints clustered after the fee-schedule change.** 15 of the 25 fee complaints arrived in June to August. The busiest month overall was Jun. *Next: Review how the new schedule is explained to existing clients.*
3. **Handovers add days.** Complaints caused by team handovers took 20.5 working days on average against a 15-day target (all complaints: 15.5). *Next: Keep one case owner from first contact to closure.*
4. **A training gap sits behind many upheld complaints.** 21 complaints (18%) trace to it, and 67% were upheld at least in part. *Next: Brief handlers on investigation and reply standards.*
5. **Timeliness is mixed.** 51% closed within the 15-day target; 49% did not. *Next: Report ageing cases to the weekly management meeting.*

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